

NFHS

- a large-scale, multi-round survey conducted in a representative sample of households throughout India
- IIPS, Mumbai is the nodal agency; funding: USAID, the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation, UNICEF, UNFPA, and MoHFW (Government of India)
- **Goals:** i.) To provide essential data on health and family welfare needed by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare and other agencies for policy and programme purposes.
ii.) To provide information on important emerging health and family welfare issues
- NFHS-1(1992-93), NFHS-2(1998-99), NFHS-3(2005-06), NFHS-4(2014-15), NFHS-5(2019-21)
- The NFHS-5 sample is a stratified two-stage sample. The 2011 census served as the sampling frame for the selection of PSUs. PSUs were villages in rural areas and Census Enumeration Blocks (CEBs) in urban areas. PSUs with fewer than 40 households were linked to the nearest PSU. Within each rural stratum, villages were selected from the sampling frame with probability proportional to size (PPS). In each stratum, six approximately equal substrata were created by crossing three substrata, each created based on the estimated number of households in each village, with two substrata, each created based on the percentage of the population belonging to scheduled castes and scheduled tribes (SCs/STs). Within each explicit sampling stratum, PSUs were sorted according to the prevalence of literacy of women age 6+ years. The final sample PSUs were selected with PPS systematic sampling.

- In urban areas, CEB information was obtained from the Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, New Delhi. CEBs were sorted according to the percentage of the SC/ST population in each CEB, and sample CEBs were selected with PPS systematic sampling. In every selected rural and urban PSU, a complete household mapping and listing operation was conducted prior to the main survey. Selected PSUs with an estimated number of at least 300 households were segmented into segments of approximately 100-150 households. Two of the segments were randomly selected for the survey using systematic sampling with probability proportional to segment size. Therefore, an NFHS-5 cluster is either a PSU or a segment of a PSU. In the second stage, in every selected rural and urban cluster, 22 households were randomly selected with systematic sampling.
- Many people are highlighting that sex ratio has increased from 991 (NFHS 4) to 1020 (NFHS 5). This interpretation should be done a bit carefully. Reason is that NFHS has a special definition of 'household' which is called 'modified de jure'. It is neither de facto nor de jure. That is why, around 30 crore single male migrants who are existing in this country cannot be listed as usual residents of their own households. They are the usual member of the household but they are not the usual resident of the household and that is why they would not be included in their household population.

NFHS also considers visitors who stayed last night and in our country these visitors are largely girls who are visiting their parental homes.

Hence while interpreting increasing sex ratio these two points should also be noted.

- Def.:

Household

A person or group of related or unrelated persons who live together in the same dwelling unit(s), who acknowledge one adult male or female as the head of the household, who share the same housekeeping arrangements, and who are considered a single unit.

De facto population

All persons who stayed in the selected households the night before the interview (whether usual residents or visitors).

De jure population

All persons who are usual residents of the selected households, whether or not they stayed in the household the night before the interview.

How data are calculated

All tables are based on the *de facto* population, unless specified otherwise.